FOCAL

MENG 570 · PROTOTYPE REVIEW · TEAM 5

Three prototypes, three hypotheses

Which way should Focal help people act on their vision?

Haydn Stucker
CEO

Burak Donbekci
CTO

Hadley McCormack
CFO

Fan Zhang
CCO

Qingyi Hu
CPO

THE PROBLEM

Convenient or thorough: pick one

2.2 billion

people live with a vision impairment. At least 1 billion of those cases were preventable or not yet addressed.

Access is hard

Even a basic check means a clinic visit and a wait.

Change is hard to see

One snapshot can’t show a trend, and kids memorize home charts.

Online tests aren’t trusted

No credible source behind them, and a number with no next step.

Source: WHO, World report on vision (2019)

HOW OUR THINKING CHANGED

What we knew then vs. now

When we started

- The barrier is access: exams are hard to book.
- People need a more accurate test.
- Big institutional buyers: DMVs, airlines, pilots.

After 10 interviews

- Avoidance isn’t only logistics: “maybe I’m fine” feels safer.
- Urgency comes from outside: a prescription, a school letter, a DMV date.
- Trust and a next step matter more than accuracy.
- Pilots dropped. Licensing agencies stay a hypothesis.

10 interviews · 4 personas · 5 in person, 5 virtual (AI-simulated personas)

OUR EXPERIMENT

Same job, three ways to help

Every version serves the job we heard in every interview: **“Has my vision changed, and do I need to see an eye doctor?”** They differ in how much Focal judges for you.

Less judgment → **More judgment**

B · PARENT PAT

Focal Family

The parent decides what it means. No score at all.

A · RILEY

Focal Monitor

You read the trend. Focal shows the change.

C · ALEX

DMV Pre-Check

Focal gives a verdict against a real rule.

PROTOTYPE A · ROUTINE-CHECK RILEY

Focal Monitor

HYPOTHESIS

Adults who notice their vision slipping will find ongoing tracking more useful than a single test result.

SUCCESS SIGNAL (PROPOSED)

3 of 5 Riley-like testers state a format preference and explain why.

THE CORE FLOW

1. An eight-letter tumbling-E check
2. Today’s result, shown on its own
3. The same result on a seven-week trend (illustrative history)
4. Neutral feedback: which view helped, and would you return?

WHY WE BELIEVE IT

Riley goes by feel, with “no baseline to compare against.” A single score can’t show change.

PROTOTYPE B · PARENT PAT

Focal Family

HYPOTHESIS

Parents will finish a short picture game with their child, then use what they noticed to pick a next step.

SUCCESS SIGNAL (PROPOSED)

4 of 5 parents finish unaided; 3 of 5 prepare an appointment or school contact.

THE CORE FLOW

1. Practice, then six large matching pictures
2. The parent notes what they've noticed
3. The parent picks a next step and prepares questions
4. A summary to bring along. No score, by design.

WHY WE BELIEVE IT

Kids memorize home charts, and Pat wants "a reasonable reason to get it checked."

PROTOTYPE C · ANXIOUS APPLICANT ALEX

DMV Pre-Check

HYPOTHESIS

People with a DMV eye test coming up will prefer, and act on, a check that answers “Will I pass my state’s test?”

SUCCESS SIGNAL (PROPOSED)

60% with a DMV visit coming up would use it; 50% told to see a doctor first would book before the DMV.

THE CORE FLOW

1. Pick your state and see its real rule
2. Size the letters to your screen with any ID card
3. Read 14 letters, six at the line that decides
4. Get a verdict and a next-step plan

WHY WE BELIEVE IT

An online test gave Alex “20/30,” and he “didn’t even know if that’s a pass or a fail.”

SIDE BY SIDE

What the comparison can teach us

	A · Focal Monitor	B · Focal Family	C · DMV Pre-Check
Persona and trigger	Riley · a prescription expiring	Pat · a school letter	Alex · a DMV date
Who judges	You read the trend	The parent decides	Focal gives a verdict
How it’s used	Repeated checks over time	One shared moment with a child	One check before a deadline
Business role	Premium personal tracking	School nurse and pediatric channel	Free DMV checker that brings users in
If it wins	Tracking is the value	Support beats judgment	People want a clear answer

Business roles come from our Lean Canvas revenue streams and channels

LIVE DEMO · ABOUT TWO MINUTES EACH

See it work

A

Focal Monitor · watch the same result shown alone, then on a trend

focal-demo-a.streamlit.app

B

Focal Family · watch a parent turn observations into a next step

focal-demo-b.streamlit.app

C

DMV Pre-Check · watch a verdict against North Carolina’s real rule

focal-demo-c.streamlit.app

WHY WE BUILT IT THIS WAY

Built from customer quotes

“No baseline to compare against.”

Riley · virtual interview

SO A SHOWS

A trend next to today’s result

“I want to know when there is a reasonable reason to get it checked.”

Pat · virtual interview

SO B OFFERS

Observations that lead to one next step

“I didn’t even know if that’s a pass or a fail.”

Alex · virtual interview

SO C GIVES

A verdict against your state’s real rule

Virtual interviews were AI-simulated personas; in-person interviews backed the same themes

PRIORITIZATION

What we kept, what we cut

Version	Tests one thing	Cut on purpose	Right call?
A · Monitor	Single result vs. trend	Real history and accounts	Yes for preference; not for return visits
B · Family	Observations → next step	Any score, camera, provider search	Yes. Open question: do parents want a number?
C · Pre-Check	Verdict vs. general score	Per-eye testing, 45 states, agency view	Mostly. Per-eye testing matters in CA and TX

Our biggest cut: no prototype for licensing agencies. Lisa's needs come only from AI-simulated interviews, so we test consumers first.

All three skip accounts, stored data, real booking and clinical validation

HONEST LIMITS

What these prototypes can’t tell us

Not clinical

Nothing here is validated against a clinical eye chart.

Thin evidence

Ten interviews, half of them AI-simulated personas.

One market untested

No prototype covers licensing agencies (Lisa).

Votes aren’t actions

A vote shows appeal, not who books an eye exam.

STRATEGY

What three versions tell us

1

Trust and a next step are the product

Every version ends in a concrete next step, not a bare score.

2

Real-world triggers bring people in

Each version hooks onto a moment that already forces action.

3

One check, different front doors

The check can be shared; the persona decides how the result is framed.

> **Our pre-vote lean:** [Team: which version, and why, in one sentence]

THE CLASS VOTE

How we'll read the vote

IF A WINS

Tracking is the value

Next: real accounts and history; test if people return.

IF B WINS

Support beats judgment

Next: real parents, via school nurses and pediatricians.

IF C WINS

People want a clear answer

Next: launch the free checker; validate DMVs with real staff.

One caveat: this room is mostly students, close to Riley and Alex but not to parents. A low B vote may say more about the room than about parents.

YOUR TURN

Which one would you actually use?

A

Focal Monitor

focal-demo-a.streamlit.app

B

Focal Family

focal-demo-b.streamlit.app

C

DMV Pre-Check

focal-demo-c.streamlit.app

Thank you · Haydn, Burak, Hadley, Fan and Qingyi · Focal, Team 5